FROM SALES TO SAAS · EPISODE 01

Why I Started Building

Recording script · 6 blocks · record each block as its own file

Files: EP01_NARR_01.wav … EP01_NARR_06.wav (48 kHz). Read naturally in your own pace; the edit will be stretched to fit your delivery. Leave a short pause between paragraphs. Read the disclaimer in block 3 word for word.

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BLOCK 01 · COLD OPEN

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I started building software because I had a problem I couldn't solve the way I wanted to.

I was trying to sell pigs, and I couldn't find the right way to connect with buyers at a price I believed they were worth.

At the time, I wasn't a software developer. I was coming from sales, customer service, and online business.

But that one problem eventually led me to build Agriloop, a marketplace designed to connect farmers with consumers.

And that changed the direction I was taking with my work.

This is not a story about building a million-dollar company overnight. It's about what happens when someone from a completely different background decides to learn how to build software, tries to turn a real problem into a product, and discovers that

getting the product working is only one part of the job.

I'm Andrew, and this is the journey from sales to SaaS.

BLOCK 02 · SALES AND CUSTOMER SERVICE

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Before software, I spent time working in sales, customer service, and corporate environments.

One of the biggest lessons I learned was that people aren't always buying the thing you're selling. They're buying what that thing means to them.

In one of my roles, I worked around security systems. The customer wasn't simply buying equipment. They wanted to feel safe. They wanted peace of mind.

That changed how I thought about sales.

You have to understand what matters to the customer, what the company can actually deliver, and how to find a solution that makes sense for both sides.

I also learned that a customer's problem can have more than one layer.

For example, when helping people with flight bookings, I dealt with a family of four travelling with eight bags. The baggage rules created another

problem they hadn't fully accounted for. I looked at the situation from their perspective and offered an option for the extra baggage.

It was a simple lesson: don't just respond to the first thing someone says. Understand the situation they're actually trying to solve.

BLOCK 03 · ONLINE BUSINESS AND YARDSCALE

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That way of thinking followed me into online business.

I started building my own experience around trading and other online ventures. I've spent approximately seven years trading, although my results are not where I want them to be.

> This is a software project, not trading advice. Trading is high risk and you can lose money. My own trading results aren't where I want them to be, and nothing here is a recommendation to buy or sell anything.

I also started YardScale Digital, working around websites, marketing, lead generation, and digital systems.

I was learning how to find customers, explain an offer, understand what a business needed, and turn that into something I could deliver.

One of the things I learned is that what a client expects and what can realistically be delivered

within a particular budget are not always the same thing.

That pushed me to think more seriously about the kind of business I wanted to build long term.

BLOCK 04 · DISCOVERING AI-ASSISTED DEVELOPMENT

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Then I had an experience that changed how I looked at software.

I came across a client who had an app. That made me think differently about what I could offer and what I could build myself.

I had already been experimenting with AI tools. I started using them to help with websites, and I realised they could shorten the time it took to turn an idea into something working.

I began learning more through research, YouTube, experimenting, and asking AI to explain things to me.

I started with ChatGPT and later used Claude heavily, especially for development.

I wasn't an expert programmer. I had taught myself some coding concepts and languages, but I still had a lot to learn.

A client who already had an app helped me see that software development could become part of the

work I did. Without that experience, I might have continued focusing mainly on agency services. My uncle also kept reminding me that I was only scratching the surface of what AI could do, and encouraged me to become better at explaining what I wanted from these tools.

The important shift was that I could now guide the process: describe the outcome, understand the structure, review what was being created, test it, and keep improving. I still had to make the decisions. AI could help me move faster, but it could not decide what customers needed or whether a business idea made sense.

My first experiments were not all serious business products. I worked on websites, tried building a game, and explored different app ideas. Some of those experiments went nowhere. But each one taught me something about turning an idea into a working product, and about the difference between getting something to run and making something people actually want.

Over a relatively short period, I created around 35 repositories. That doesn't mean I created 35 successful businesses. It means I was experimenting, learning, and getting more comfortable with the tools and the process.

I was also beginning to see a different opportunity for YardScale. Instead of only helping businesses with marketing and websites, I could move further into building software products and working through the problems behind them.

BLOCK 05 · THE AGRILOOP IDEA

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Then came the problem that led to Agriloop.

I had been trying to sell pigs. I believed they were worth a certain price, but finding the right buyer was difficult.

I started looking at how people were using social media and other online spaces to sell livestock and produce.

I began thinking about a marketplace where farmers could connect with buyers in their own parish and neighbouring parishes.

That became Agriloop.

Development started on 13 September 2026.

The first idea was straightforward: give farmers a way to create listings and give buyers a way to discover what was available.

But turning that idea into software meant learning a lot more than I expected.

There were databases, user accounts, listings, messaging, design decisions, bugs, and a lot of small details that had to work together.

I kept working through those challenges until Agriloop reached a working beta.

BLOCK 06 · THE REAL BEGINNING

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And that's where this journey really starts.

Because getting an app to work is not the same as building a business.

You still have to find the right people, understand whether the problem matters enough, earn trust, and give customers a reason to use what you've built.

I am still figuring those things out.

In this series, I'm going to break down the decisions, the tools, the mistakes, and the lessons behind building software products from the ground up.

Not just the finished screens. The thinking behind them.

And the first question we need to answer is simple:

How do you find a problem worth solving?